DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 2

Data entry specialist

Profession 2 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A data entry specialist enters, checks and cleans information from documents or forms into systems and spreadsheets.

What professionals do every day

Enters records from source documents, checks them against rules, flags doubtful entries, and reports error rates.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Accurate records are the foundation of every report and customer contact. Data entry done carefully saves far more time later.

- Typing errors that spread into reports.
- Duplicates across systems.
- Unclear source documents.

Skills you need

- Fast accurate typing.
- Validation rules.
- Spreadsheet basics.
- Confidentiality.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Google Workspace	Mail, calendar, documents	Free personal account	Paid business plans	workspace.google.com
Microsoft 365	Outlook, Excel, Word, Teams	Free web apps	Paid plans	www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365
OpenRefine	Clean messy data (free, open source)	Free	Free	openrefine.org

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Enter 50 records and count your errors.
Intermediate	Write a validation list for one form.
Advanced	Find and merge five duplicate records.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Customer list cleanup.
- **Intermediate:** Invoice data entry.
- **Advanced:** Survey data entry.

Client-ready portfolio project

A data entry pack for a fictional clinic: 50 records entered from a sample form, a validation checklist, duplicate check and an error report.

Worked example

Worked example. A phone number is entered as '98765 43210'; the validation step strips spaces and confirms ten digits before saving.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Validate and report

Business problem: A clinic's patient list needs clean phone numbers and emails before import.

Steps

1. Run each record through the validator (see the Module B code).
2. Count the records with errors and group the errors by type.
3. Correct each error from the source form, not from memory.
4. Report the error rate.

Expected output: The error list and the error rate.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

PYTHON

```
from admin_tools import validate_record
records = [
    {'name':'Asha','email':'asha@example.com','phone':'98765 43210'},
    {'name':'','email':'bad','phone':'123'},
]
for r in records:
    print(validate_record(r) or 'ok')
```

The first record passes; the second returns three problems. The error rate is 1 record in 2 (50%) for this sample; a real list would be checked in full.

Common mistakes

- Typing from memory.
- No second check on critical fields.

- Skipping duplicate checks.
- Storing source documents without access control.

Freelancing opportunities

- Data cleanup projects for small firms.
- Recurring entry work with quality checks.
- Briefs for 'data entry', 'data cleaning', 'spreadsheet entry'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- OpenRefine documentation

Part of **Master Freelancing: Admin and Business Support**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.